

1. Definition of Tag Question (परिभाषा)

English

A tag question is a short question added at the end of a statement to ask for confirmation, agreement, or information.

नेपाली

Tag Question (प्रश्न पुच्छर) भनेको कुनै वाक्यको अन्त्यमा थपिने सानो प्रश्न हो, जसले पुष्टि (confirmation), सहमति (agreement), वा जानकारी माग्ने काम गर्छ।

Examples

- You are a student, aren't you?

तिमी विद्यार्थी हौ, होइन?

- She can't swim, can she?

उनी पौडिन सकिदैनन्, सकिछन् र?

2. Structure of Tag Question (बनोट)

Formula

Positive Statement + Negative Tag

OR

Negative Statement + Positive Tag

Examples

Statement	Tag Question
You are happy,	aren't you?
She isn't here,	is she?
They have finished,	haven't they?
He can't drive,	can he?

3. Auxiliary Verbs Used in Tag Questions

A. Be Verbs

Auxiliary	Negative Short Form	Example
am	aren't*	I'm late, aren't I?
is	isn't	She is kind, isn't she?
are	aren't	They are ready, aren't they?
was	wasn't	He was sick, wasn't he?
were	weren't	We were late, weren't we?

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Auxiliary	Negative Short Form	उदाहरण
am	aren't	म ढिलो भएँ, होइन र?
is	isn't	उनी दयालु छन्, होइन?
are	aren't	उनीहरू तयार छन्, होइन?
was	wasn't	ऊ बिरामी थियो, होइन?
were	weren't	हामी ढिलो भएका थियौं, होइन?

Special Note: Although *amn't I* is grammatically possible in some dialects, standard English uses **aren't I?** after I am.

B. Do Verbs

Auxiliary	Negative Short Form	Example
do	don't	You like tea, don't you?
does	doesn't	She sings, doesn't she?
did	didn't	They came, didn't they?

C. Have Verbs

Auxiliary	Negative Short Form	Example
have	haven't	You have finished, haven't you?
has	hasn't	He has eaten, hasn't he?
had	hadn't	She had left, hadn't she?

D. Modal Auxiliaries

Auxiliary	Negative Short Form	Example
can	can't	You can swim, can't you?
could	couldn't	She could sing, couldn't she?
will	won't	He will come, won't he?
would	wouldn't	They would help, wouldn't they?
shall	shan't	We shall win, shan't we?
should	shouldn't	You should study, shouldn't you?
may	mayn't (rare)	He may come, mayn't he?
might	mightn't	She might leave, mightn't she?
must	mustn't	You must obey, mustn't you?
ought to	oughtn't to	We ought to help, oughtn't we?
need (modal)	needn't	You needn't worry, need you?
dare (modal)	daren't	He daren't speak, dare he?

Rules of Tag Questions (Tag Question का नियमहरू)

Rule 1: Positive Statement → Negative Tag

English

If the statement is positive, the tag becomes negative.

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यदि वाक्य सकारात्मक छ भने Tag नकारात्मक हुन्छ।

Examples

- **She is beautiful, isn't she?**
- **They play football, don't they?**

Rule 2: Negative Statement → Positive Tag

Examples

- **He isn't tired, is he?**
- **You don't smoke, do you?**

Rule 3: Same Auxiliary Must Be Used

Examples

- **He is late**, isn't **he**?
 - **They have arrived**, haven't **they**?
-

Rule 4: If There Is No Auxiliary, Use Do / Does / Did

Examples

- **You like music**, don't you?
 - **She works hard**, doesn't she?
 - **He went home**, didn't he?
-

Rule 5: Pronoun Must Replace the Subject

Subject	Pronoun
Ram	he
Sita	she
Ram and Hari	they
The students	they
The book	it
Your parents	they

Examples

- **Ram is honest**, isn't he?
 - **The book is new**, isn't it?
-

Rule 6: I am → aren't I?

Example

- **I'm your friend**, aren't I?
-

Rule 7: Imperative Sentences

Requests

- **Open the door**, will you?
- **Pass me the salt**, will you?

Invitations

- **Let's go**, shall we?

Commands

- **Don't make noise**, will you?

Rule 8: Nobody, Someone, Everyone आदि

Subject	Tag Pronoun
Everyone	they
Someone	they
Nobody	they
Anybody	they
No one	They

Examples

- **Everyone is ready, aren't they?**
- **Nobody came, did they?**

Rule 9: This / That / These / Those

Subject	Pronoun
This	it
That	it
These	they
Those	they

Examples

- **This is your pen, isn't it?**
- **These are yours, aren't they?**

Rule 10: There is / There are

Examples

- **There is a cat, isn't there?**
- **There aren't many people, are there?**

Rule 11: Never, Hardly, Rarely, Seldom, Scarcely

These words make the statement negative in meaning, so use a positive tag.

Examples

- **He never lies, does he?**
- **She hardly speaks, does she?**
- **They rarely come, do they?**

Rule 12: Nothing / Something / Everything

Subject	Tag
Nothing	is it? / does it? (depends on the main verb)
Something	isn't it? / doesn't it?
Everything	isn't it?
All+is	isn't it?
All+are	aren't they?

Examples

- **Nothing happened**, did it?
- **Everything is ready**, isn't it?

Rule 13: Used to

- **He used to smoke**, didn't he?

Rule 14: Need and Dare

If used as main verbs, use do/does/did.

- **He needs help**, doesn't he?

If used as modal verbs, use need/dare.

- **You needn't worry**, need you?

Rule 15: Let's

- **Let's start**, shall we?

5. Intonation in Tag Questions (स्वर)

Falling Intonation (📉)

Used when the speaker expects agreement.

- **It's hot today**, isn't it? 📉

Rising Intonation (📈)

Used when the speaker is genuinely asking.

- **You met him yesterday**, didn't you? 📈

6. Common Tag Questions

Statement	Tag
I am	aren't I?
I'm not	am I?
Let's	shall we?
Open the door	will you?
Don't be late	will you?
Everyone	aren't they?
Nobody	did they?
This	isn't it?
There is	isn't there?
There are	aren't there?

7. Summary (सारांश)

- ✓ **Positive statement → Negative tag**
- ✓ **Negative statement → Positive tag**
- ✓ **Use the same auxiliary verb in the tag.**
- ✓ **If there is no auxiliary, use do/does/did.**
- ✓ **Replace the subject with the correct pronoun.**
- ✓ **Use aren't I? after I am.**
- ✓ **Use shall we? after Let's.**
- ✓ **Use will you? with most imperatives.**
- ✓ **Words like never, hardly, rarely, scarcely, seldom, no one, nobody make the statement negative in meaning, so use a positive tag.**
- ✓ **Match the tense, auxiliary, and subject pronoun correctly.**

All Pronouns and Their Tag Questions (English + Nepali Bilingual Guide)

In tag questions, the subject of the statement is replaced by an appropriate subject pronoun in the tag.

Formula (सूत्र):

- Positive statement + Negative tag

- Negative statement + Positive tag

नेपाली:

Tag Question मा मुख्य वाक्यको Subject लाई उपयुक्त Subject Pronoun ले बदलिन्छ।

1. Personal Pronouns (व्यक्तिवाचक सर्वनाम)

Subject	Tag Pronoun	Example	
I	I	I am late, aren't I?	म ढिलो भएँ,
You	you	You are ready, aren't you?	तिमी/तपाईं त
He	he	He is a teacher, isn't he?	ऊ शिक्षक हो.
She	she	She sings well, doesn't she?	उनी राम्रो गा.
It	it	It is raining, isn't it?	पानी परिरहेक
We	we	We can win, can't we?	हामी जित्न स
They	they	They came early, didn't they?	उनीहरू चाँडै

2. Demonstrative Pronouns (संकेतवाचक सर्वनाम)

Pronoun	Tag Pronoun	Example
This	it	This is your pen, isn't it?
That	it	That was easy, wasn't it?
These	they	These are yours, aren't they?
Those	they	Those were expensive, weren't they?

नेपाली

- **This** → it
- **That** → it
- **These** → they

- Those → they

3. Indefinite Pronouns (अनिश्चित सर्वनाम)

Pronoun	Tag Pronoun	Example
Everyone	they	Everyone is here, aren't they?
Everybody	they	Everybody knows, don't they?
Someone	they	Someone called, didn't they?
Somebody	they	Somebody is waiting, aren't they?
Anyone	they	Anyone can do it, can't they?
Anybody	they	Anybody knows, don't they?
No one	they	No one came, did they?
Nobody	they	Nobody was absent, were they?
None	they	None agreed, did they?

नेपाली

यी सबैका लागि सामान्यतया they प्रयोग गरिन्छ।

4. Compound Indefinite Pronouns

Pronoun	Tag
Everyone	they
Everybody	they
Everything	it
Someone	they
Somebody	they
Something	it
Anyone	they
Anybody	they
Anything	it
Nobody	they
Nothing	it

No one	they
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5. Relative Pronouns (सम्बन्धवाचक सर्वनाम)

Relative pronouns normally do not appear directly in tag questions. The tag agrees with the antecedent (the noun they refer to).

Sentence	Tag
The boy who came is my friend,	isn't he?
The girl who won is smart,	isn't she?
The books that are on the table are mine,	aren't they?

6. Interrogative Pronouns (प्रश्नवाचक सर्वनाम)

Tag questions are generally not used with direct interrogative pronouns because the sentence is already a question.

Examples:

- Who are you?
- What happened?

7. Reciprocal Pronouns (पारस्परिक सर्वनाम)

Pronoun	Tag Pronoun
Each other	they
One another	they

Example:

- They help each other, don't they?

8. Reflexive Pronouns (आत्मवाचक सर्वनाम)

Reflexive pronouns never become the tag subject. The tag uses the original subject pronoun.

Sentence	Tag
He hurt himself,	didn't he?
She enjoyed herself,	didn't she?
We introduced ourselves,	didn't we?

9. Possessive Pronouns (स्वामित्ववाचक सर्वनाम)

The tag depends on the subject, not on the possessive pronoun.

Sentence	Tag
Mine is expensive,	isn't it?
Yours is beautiful,	isn't it?
Ours was ready,	wasn't it?
Theirs is new,	isn't it?

10. Special Subjects

Subject	Tag Pronoun	Example
There	there	There is a book, isn't there?
There	there	There were many students, weren't there?
One	one	One should obey the law, shouldn't one? <i>(Formal)</i>
One	they	One should obey the law, shouldn't they? <i>(Modern informal English)</i>

11. Complete Pronoun-to-Tag Chart

Subject	Tag Pronoun	नेपाली
I	I	म
You	you	तिमी/तपाईं
He	he	ऊ
She	she	उनी
It	it	यो/त्यो वस्तु
We	we	हामी
They	they	उनीहरू

This	it	यो
That	it	त्यो
These	they	यी
Those	they	ती
Everyone	they	सबै जना
Everybody	they	सबै जना
Someone	they	कोही
Somebody	they	कोही
Anyone	they	जोसुकै
Anybody	they	जोसुकै
No one	they	कोही पनि होइन
Nobody	they	कोही पनि होइन
None	they	कुनै पनि होइन
Everything	it	सबै कुरा
Something	it	केही कुरा
Anything	it	जे पनि
Nothing	it	केही पनि होइन
There	there	त्यहाँ
One	one / they	कुनै व्यक्ति (सामान्य अर्थमा)

Important Notes (महत्वपूर्ण नियम)

1. I am → aren't I?

◦ *I'm your friend, aren't I?*

म तिम्रो साथी हुँ, होइन र?

2. Everyone, somebody, nobody, anyone, no one → they
 - *Everyone has finished, haven't they?*
3. Everything, something, nothing, anything → it
 - *Everything is ready, isn't it?*
4. This / That → it
 - *That is beautiful, isn't it?*
5. These / Those → they
 - *Those are expensive, aren't they?*

Combinations of Nouns and Pronouns and Their Tag Questions (English + Nepali Bilingual Guide)

In tag questions, the subject of the main sentence is replaced by the correct subject pronoun in the tag.

Formula (सूत्र):

- Positive Statement + Negative Tag
- Negative Statement + Positive Tag

नेपाली:

Tag Question मा मुख्य वाक्यको Subject (कर्ता) लाई उपयुक्त Subject Pronoun (सर्वनाम) ले प्रतिस्थापन गरिन्छ।

A. Single Noun → Tag Pronoun

Subject (Noun)	Tag Pronoun	Example	नेपाली
Ram	he	Ram is honest, isn't he?	राम इमानदार छन्, होइन?
Sita	she	Sita dances well, doesn't she?	सीता राम्रो नाच्छिन्, होइन?
The boy	he	The boy is playing, isn't he?	केटा खेलिरहेको छ, होइन?

The girl	she	The girl sings, doesn't she?	केटी गाउँछे, होइन?
The dog	it	The dog is barking, isn't it?	कुकुर भुकिरहेको छ, होइन?
The cat	it	The cat slept, didn't it?	बिरालो सुत्यो, होइन?
The book	it	The book is interesting, isn't it?	किताब रोचक छ, होइन?
My school	it	My school is big, isn't it?	मेरो विद्यालय ठूलो छ, होइन?

B. Two Singular Nouns Joined by and

Subject	Tag Pronoun	Example
Ram and Hari	they	Ram and Hari are friends, aren't they?
Sita and Gita	they	Sita and Gita came, didn't they?
Father and mother	they	Father and mother are home, aren't they?

नेपाली:

and ले जोडिएका दुई वा बढी Subject → they

C. Noun + Pronoun

Subject	Tag	Example
Ram and I	we	Ram and I are ready, aren't we?
You and I	we	You and I can win, can't we?
Ram and you	you	Ram and you are late, aren't you?
He and I	we	He and I were classmates, weren't we?
She and I	we	She and I work together, don't we?
You and he	you	You and he are friends, aren't you?
You and she	you	You and she have finished, haven't you?

Note: **In English conversation, when you is part of the subject, the tag commonly uses you if it addresses the listener directly. If the speaker is included (I + another person), the tag is we.**

D. Pronoun + Pronoun

Subject	Tag
He and she	they
He and you	you
She and you	you
He and I	we
She and I	we
We and you*	we/you (avoid this construction)
They and I	we
They and you	you

Examples

- He and she are happy, aren't they?
- She and I are classmates, aren't we?
- You and he know the answer, don't you?

E. Collective Nouns (समूहवाचक संज्ञा)

Subject	Tag
The team	it / they*
The committee	it / they*
The family	it / they*
The class	it
The jury	it / they*

Examples

- The team is winning, isn't it?
- The team are arguing among themselves, aren't they? (*British English*)

नेपाली:

यदि समूहलाई एक इकाई (single unit) को रूपमा हेरेमा it प्रयोग हुन्छ।

यदि सदस्यहरूलाई अलग-अलग रूपमा जोड दिइएको छ भने (विशेषगरी **British English** मा) they प्रयोग हुन सक्छ।

F. Indefinite Pronouns

Subject	Tag
Everyone	they
Everybody	they
Someone	they
Somebody	they
Anyone	they
Anybody	they
No one	they
Nobody	they
None	they

Examples

- **Everyone passed, didn't they?**
- **Nobody called, did they?**

G. Things

Subject	Tag
Everything	it
Something	it
Nothing	it
Anything	it

Examples

- **Everything is ready, isn't it?**
- **Nothing happened, did it?**

H. Demonstratives

Subject	Tag
This	it
That	it

These	they
Those	they

I. There Structure

Subject	Tag
There is	isn't there?
There are	aren't there?
There was	wasn't there?
There were	weren't there?

Examples

- **There is a pen**, isn't there?
- **There weren't many students**, were there?

J. One

Subject	Tag
One	one (<i>formal</i>) / they (<i>common modern English</i>)

Example

- **One should obey the law**, shouldn't one?
- **One should obey the law**, shouldn't they?

K. Compound Nouns

Subject	Tag
My brother	he
My sister	she
My parents	they
My grandparents	they
My uncle	he
My aunt	she
My friend (male)	he
My friend (female)	she
My friends	they
My children	they
My baby	it / he / she (depending on context)

L. Animals

Subject	Tag
The lion	it
The elephant	it
The cow	it
My pet dog	it / he / she (if the sex is known or treated as a family pet)

M. Organizations, Countries, and Institutions

Subject	Tag
The government	it
The company	it
The school	it
Nepal	it
India	it
The police	they

Examples

- **The school is closed, isn't it?**
- **The police have arrived, haven't they?**

Summary Chart (सारांश तालिका)

Subject	Tag Pronoun	नेपाली
One male noun	he	पुलिङ्ग व्यक्ति
One female noun	she	स्त्रीलिङ्ग व्यक्ति
One thing/animal	it	वस्तु वा जनावर
Two or more nouns	they	दुई वा बढी व्यक्ति/वस्तु
I + another person	we	म र अर्को व्यक्ति

You + another person	you	तिमी/तपाईं र अर्को व्यक्ति
Everyone / Someone / Nobody	they	सबै/कोही/कोही पनि होइन
Everything / Nothing	it	सबै कुरा/केही पनि होइन
This / That	it	यो/त्यो
These / Those	they	यी/ती
There	there	त्यहाँ
Police	they	प्रहरी
Team / Committee	it / they	समूह (सन्दर्भअनुसार)

Important Notes (महत्वपूर्ण नियम)

- Ram and I → we
- You and I → we
- Ram and Hari → they
- Ram and you → you
- Everyone, someone, nobody → they
- Everything, nothing → it
- This/That → it
- These/Those → they
- The police **is grammatically plural, so use they.**
- Collective nouns (e.g., *team, committee, family*) usually take it in American English when treated as a single unit, but may take they in British English when referring to the individual members.

Sentence with non-binary/third gender/तेस्रो लिङ्गी

Alex is non-binary.

Tag Question

When a non-binary person uses they/them pronouns, the tag question usually uses **they**:

- Alex is non-binary, aren't they?

More Examples

1. Sam is non-binary, aren't they?
 - Sam non-binary छन्, होइन र?
2. Taylor identifies as non-binary, don't they?
 - Taylor आफूलाई non-binary भनेर चिनाउँछन्, होइन र?

Rule (Bilingual)

- **If the subject is a non-binary person who uses they/them pronouns, use they in the tag question.**
 - Jordan is non-binary, aren't they?
 - Jordan likes music, don't they?

Tag Questions with Compound Sentences

1. Definition

English:

A compound sentence consists of two or more independent clauses joined by coordinating conjunctions such as and, but, or, nor, for, so, yet.

Nepali:

Compound sentence भनेको and, but, or, nor, for, so, yet जस्ता **coordinating conjunction** हरूद्वारा जोडिएका दुई वा दुईभन्दा बढी स्वतन्त्र उपवाक्य (**independent clauses**) भएको वाक्य हो।

Rules of Tag Questions with Compound Sentences

Rule 1: Tag is usually based on the last clause

English:

When a compound sentence has two clauses joined by a conjunction, the tag question is generally formed from the last clause.

Nepali:

जब **compound sentence** मा दुईवटा **clause** हुन्छन्, **tag question** प्रायः **अन्तिम** **clause** का आधारमा बनाइन्छ।

Examples:

- **Ram is a teacher and Sita is a nurse, isn't she?**
- राम शिक्षक हुन् र सीता नर्स हुन्, हैन र?
- **He worked hard but he failed, didn't he?**
- उसले धेरै मेहनत गर्‍यो तर ऊ असफल भयो, होइन र?

Rule 2: When both clauses have the same subject

English:

If both clauses have the same subject, make the tag from the auxiliary verb of the last clause.

Nepali:

यदि दुवै **clause** को **subject** एउटै छ भने **अन्तिम clause** को **auxiliary verb** अनुसार **tag** बनाइन्छ।

Examples:

- **She sang and danced well, didn't she?**
- उसले राम्रोसँग गायो र नाची, होइन र?
- **He studied hard and passed the exam, didn't he?**
- उसले मेहनत गरेर पढ्यो र परीक्षा पास गर्‍यो, होइन र?

Rule 3: Sentences joined by "and"

English:

For clauses connected by and, use the tag of the second clause.

Nepali:

and ले जोडिएका **clause** हरूमा दोस्रो **clause** को आधारमा **tag** बनाइन्छ।

Examples:

- Ram came and Sita helped him, didn't she?
 - राम आयो र सीताले उसलाई सहयोग गरिन्, होइन र?
-

Rule 4: Sentences joined by "but"

English:

When clauses are joined by but, form the tag from the second clause.

Nepali:

but ले जोडिएका वाक्यमा दोस्रो clause बाट tag बनाइन्छ।

Examples:

- He is poor but he is honest, isn't he?
 - ऊ गरिब छ तर ऊ इमानदार छ, हैन र?
 - She tried hard but she couldn't win, could she?
 - उसले धेरै प्रयास गरिन् तर जित्न सकिनन्, सकिन् र?
-

Rule 5: Sentences joined by "or"

English:

With or, the tag usually follows the second clause.

Nepali:

or ले जोडिएका वाक्यमा पनि दोस्रो clause अनुसार tag बनाइन्छ।

Examples:

- You will come or he will come, won't he?
 - तिमी आउनेछौ वा ऊ आउनेछ, आउनेछैन र?
-

Rule 6: Imperative + and/or + statement

English:

If an imperative sentence is followed by another clause, the tag depends on the second clause.

Nepali:

Imperative sentence पछि अर्को **clause** आएमा **tag** दोस्रो **clause** अनुसार बनाइन्छ।

Examples:

- **Work hard and you will succeed, won't you?**
- मेहनत गर र तिमी सफल हुनेछौ, हुनेछैनौ र?
- **Hurry up or you will miss the bus, won't you?**
- छिटो गर, नत्र तिमी बस छुटाउनेछौ, छुटाउनेछैनौ र?

Rule 7: Compound subject joined by "and"

English:

When two subjects are joined by and, the subject becomes plural and the tag uses they.

Nepali:

जब दुई **subject** लाई **and** ले जोड्छ, **subject plural** हुन्छ र **tag** मा **they** प्रयोग हुन्छ।

Examples:

- **Ram and Hari are friends, aren't they?**
- राम र हरि साथी हुन्, हैनन् र?
- **Sita and Gita have arrived, haven't they?**
- सीता र गीता आइपुगेका छन्, आइपुगेका छैनन् र?

Quick Summary Table

Compound Sentence Type	Tag Based On	Example
Clause + and + Clause	Last Clause	He came and she left, didn't she?
Clause + but + Clause	Last Clause	He is poor but honest, isn't he?
Clause + or + Clause	Last Clause	You will go or he will go, won't he?

Imperative + and/or	Second Clause	Work hard and you will pass, won't you?
Subject + and + Subject	Plural Subject	Ram and Hari are friends, aren't they?

Golden Rule

In most compound sentences, the tag question is formed from the last independent clause.

अधिकांश compound sentences मा tag question अन्तिम independent clause का आधारमा बनाइन्छ।

Tag Questions with Causative Verbs

What are Causative Verbs?

English: Causative verbs are verbs that show that someone causes another person to do something.

Nepali: Causative verbs ले कुनै व्यक्तिले अर्को व्यक्तिबाट काम गराएको जनाउँछन्।

Common causative verbs:

- . have
- . get
- . make
- . let
- . help

Rule for Tag Questions with Causative Verbs

Tag question is formed according to the **main auxiliary verb** or the **tense of the sentence**, not according to the causative meaning.

Structure:

Statement + , + Auxiliary + Pronoun?

1. HAVE (Have something done)

Positive → Negative Tag

She had her hair cut yesterday, didn't she?

- उसले हिजो आफ्नो कपाल काटिन्, होइन र?

They have their house painted every year, don't they?

- उनीहरूले हरेक वर्ष आफ्नो घर रङ्ग लगाउँछन्, होइन र?

Negative → Positive Tag

He didn't have his car repaired, did he?

- उसले आफ्नो गाडी मर्मत गराएन, हो र?
-

2. GET (Get something done)

Positive → Negative Tag

She got her watch repaired, didn't she?

- उसले आफ्नो घडी मर्मत गराइन्, होइन र?

They got the room cleaned, didn't they?

- उनीहरूले कोठा सफा गराए, होइन र?

Negative → Positive Tag

He didn't get the work finished, did he?

- उसले काम पूरा गराएन, हो र?
-

3. MAKE (Force someone to do something)

Positive → Negative Tag

The teacher made the students work hard, didn't he/she?

- शिक्षकले विद्यार्थीहरूलाई कडा मेहनत गर्न लगाए, होइन र?

Her parents made her apologize, didn't they?

- उनका आमाबाबुले उनलाई माफी माग्न लगाए, होइन र?

Negative → Positive Tag

They didn't make him leave, did they?

- उनीहरूले उसलाई जान बाध्य पारेनन्, हो र?

4. LET (Allow someone to do something)

Positive → Negative Tag

She let me use her phone, didn't she?

- उनले मलाई आफ्नो फोन प्रयोग गर्न दिइन्, होइन र?

They let the children play outside, didn't they?

- उनीहरूले बच्चाहरूलाई बाहिर खेल्न दिए, होइन र?

Negative → Positive Tag

He didn't let us enter, did he?

- उसले हामीलाई भित्र पस्न दिएन, हो र?

5. HELP (Help someone do something)

Positive → Negative Tag

She helped me finish the work, didn't she?

- उनले मलाई काम सक्न मद्दत गरिन्, होइन र?

They helped us clean the room, didn't they?

- उनीहरूले हामीलाई कोठा सफा गर्न मद्दत गरे, होइन र?

Negative → Positive Tag

He didn't help me solve the problem, did he?

- उसले मलाई समस्या समाधान गर्न मद्दत गरेन, हो र?

Special Note

When **have, get, make, let, help** are used as ordinary verbs in the **simple present** or **simple past**, use **do/does/did** in the tag.

Examples

- She had her house painted, **didn't she?**
- He got his bike repaired, **didn't he?**
- They made him cry, **didn't they?**
- She lets her son play, **doesn't she?**
- He helps me a lot, **doesn't he?**

Quick Practice

1. She got her computer repaired, _____?
◦ **didn't she?**
2. They didn't make him apologize, _____?
◦ **did they?**
3. He lets the children play outside, _____?
◦ **doesn't he?**
4. We had our house painted, _____?
◦ **didn't we?**
5. She helped you finish the project, _____?
◦ **didn't she?**

Tag Questions Related to Direct and Indirect Speech

1. Tag Questions with Direct Speech

Rule: The tag question is formed from the **reporting clause**, not from the words inside quotation marks.

Nepali: Direct speech मा tag question reporting verb (said, asked, told, etc.) भएको भागबाट बनाइन्छ, quotation भित्रको वाक्यबाट होइन।

Structure

Reporting Clause + Tag Question + "Direct Speech"

Examples

1. He said, "I am tired," didn't he?
◦ उसले भन्यो, "म थाकेको छु," होइन र?
2. She said, "I will come tomorrow," didn't she?
◦ उनले भनिन्, "म भोलि आउनेछु," होइन र?
3. They said, "We are ready," didn't they?
◦ उनीहरूले भने, "हामी तयार छौं," होइन र?
4. Ram said, "I can do it," didn't he?

- रामले भन्यो, "म यो गर्न सक्छु," होइन र?

2. Tag Questions with Indirect Speech

Rule: The tag question is formed from the **main (reporting) clause** of the sentence.

Nepali: Indirect speech मा tag question मुख्य वाक्य (reporting clause) को auxiliary वा tense अनुसार बनाइन्छ।

Examples

1. **He said that he was tired, didn't he?**
 - उसले आफू थाकेको कुरा भन्यो, होइन र?
2. **She said that she would come the next day, didn't she?**
 - उनले अर्को दिन आउने कुरा भनिन्, होइन र?
3. **They told us that they were ready, didn't they?**
 - उनीहरूले आफूहरू तयार भएको कुरा बताए, होइन र?
4. **Ram said that he could do it, didn't he?**
 - रामले त्यो गर्न सक्ने कुरा भन्यो, होइन र?

3. Reporting Verbs and Their Tags

Reporting Verb	Tag Question
He said	didn't he?
She said	didn't she?
They said	didn't they?
Ram told me	didn't he?
Sita asked	didn't she?
We informed them	didn't we?

Examples

- **She asked me to wait, didn't she?**
 - उनले मलाई पर्खन भनिन्, होइन र?
- **They told us the truth, didn't they?**
 - उनीहरूले हामीलाई सत्य कुरा बताए, होइन र?

Important Note

When the reporting verb is in the present tense:

- **He says that he is busy, doesn't he?**
 - उसले आफू व्यस्त भएको भन्छ, होइन र?
- **She tells me everything, doesn't she?**
 - उनले मलाई सबै कुरा बताउँछिन्, होइन र?

Practice

Fill in the correct tag:

1. He said, "I am happy," _____?
 - **didn't he?**
2. She said that she was busy, _____?
 - **didn't she?**
3. They told us the news, _____?
 - **didn't they?**
4. Ram says that he knows the answer, _____?
 - **doesn't he?**
5. Sita asked me to help her, _____?
 - **didn't she?**

Key Point

Direct Speech: Tag comes from the **reporting clause**.

Indirect Speech: Tag comes from the **main/reporting clause**.

Formula:

Reporting Clause + Tag Question

Examples:

- **He said, "I am ready," didn't he?**
- **He said that he was ready, didn't he?**

Use of 's, 'd, and 've in Question Tags

In question tags, contracted forms such as 's, 'd, and 've are commonly used. Their meanings change according to the auxiliary verb they represent.

Contracted Form	Full Form	Meaning in Nepali
's	is / has	हो / छ ; गरेको छ
'd	had / would	थियो ; हुने थियो / गथर्यो

've	have	गरेको छु/छन्
-----	------	--------------

1. Use of 's (= is) in Question Tags

When 's stands for **is**, the tag uses **isn't** or **is**.

Examples:

- He's a doctor, isn't he?
 - ऊ डाक्टर हो, होइन र?
- She's very intelligent, isn't she?
 - उनी धेरै बुद्धिमान छन्, होइन र?
- It's raining, isn't it?
 - पानी परिरहेको छ, होइन र?

Rule:

's = **is** when it describes a state, quality, identity, or present continuous action.

2. Use of 's (= has) in Question Tags

When 's stands for **has**, use **hasn't** or **has** in the tag.

Examples:

- He's finished his homework, hasn't he?
 - उसले गृहकार्य पूरा गरिसकेको छ, होइन र?
- She's gone home, hasn't she?
 - उनी घर गइसकेकी छिन्, होइन र?

Rule:

When 's is followed by a **past participle (V³)**, it usually means **has**.

3. Use of 'd (= had) in Question Tags

When 'd means **had**, use **hadn't** or **had** in the tag.

Examples:

- He'd completed the work, hadn't he?
 - उसले काम पूरा गरेको थियो, होइन र?
- She'd gone before I arrived, hadn't she?
 - म पुग्नुभन्दा पहिले उनी गएकी थिइन्, होइन र?

Rule:

If 'd is followed by a **past participle (V³)**, it generally means **had**.

4. Use of 'd (= would) in Question Tags

When 'd means **would**, use **wouldn't** or **would** in the tag.

Examples:

- He'd help us, wouldn't he?
 - उसले हामीलाई सहयोग गर्थ्यो, होइन र?

- **She'd come if invited, wouldn't she?**
 - निमन्त्रणा गरिएमा उनी आउँथिन्, होइन र?

Rule:

If 'd is followed by the **base form of a verb (V¹)**, it usually means **would**.

5. Use of 've (= have) in Question Tags

When 've stands for **have**, use **haven't** or **have** in the tag.

Examples:

- **I've seen that movie, haven't I?**
 - मैले त्यो चलचित्र हेरेको छु, होइन र?
- **They've arrived, haven't they?**
 - उनीहरू आइपुगेका छन्, होइन र?
- **We've completed the project, haven't we?**
 - हामीले परियोजना पूरा गरेका छौं, होइन र?

Rule:

've always represents **have** in question tags.

Summary Table

Contraction	Meaning	Example	Tag
's	is	He's happy.	isn't he?
's	has	He's finished.	hasn't he?
'd	had	He'd gone.	hadn't he?
'd	would	He'd help.	wouldn't he?
've	have	They've arrived.	haven't they?

Important Tip (महत्वपूर्ण नियम)

- **'s + adjective/noun/V-ing → is**
- **'s + V³ (past participle) → has**
- **'d + V³ → had**
- **'d + V¹ (base verb) → would**
- **'ve → have always**

'd+better=had

'd+rather=would